Curriculum Vitae
Leo Yang Yang

Research Assistant Professor
Department of Accountancy, Economics and Finance
School of Business
Hong Kong Baptist University

leoyang@hkbu.edu.hk
https://www.leoyang.org

Academic Positions

Research Assistant Professor, Department of Accountancy, Economics and Finance, Hong Kong Baptist University, Sep 2024 - Present

Post-Doc Scholar, Center on China's Economy and Institutions, Stanford University, Feb 2024 - Aug 2024

Computational Social Science Fellow, UC Institute on Global Conflict and Cooperation, Oct 2021 - Dec 2023

Pre-Doc Fellow, Department of Political Science, Stanford University, Jan 2020 - Mar 2020

Visiting Researcher, The Center for European Economic Research (ZEW), June 2014 - July 2014

Education

Ph.D. in Political Science (Specialization in CSS), University of California San Diego, Aug 2017 - Dec 2023.

M.Phil. in Social Science, Division of Social Science, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Aug 2014 - Jul 2016.

M.A. in Finance, Wang Yanan Institute for Studies in Economics (WISE), Xiamen University, Sep 2011 - Jul 2014.

B.A. in Economics, Tan Kah Kee College, Xiamen University, Sep 2006 - Jul 2010.

Research Interests

Political Economy, Computational Social Science, and Metascience

Academic Affiliations

Faculty Affiliate, Stanford Center on China's Economy and Institutions (SCCEI)

Faculty Affiliate, UC Institute on Global Conflict and Cooperation (IGCC)

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- "Outside the Magistrate's Shadow: Media Beyond Local Authority and Cadre Promotion in China" *Journal of Comparative Economics*, forthcoming. SSRN:6604638
- "Biting the Hand That Teaches: Unraveling the Economic Impact of Banning Private Tutoring in China" *Journal of Comparative Economics* 53(4), 954-976. doi:10.1016/j.jce.2025.07.002, 2025 (with Zibin Huang, Yinan Liu, and Mingming Ma)

- "Robot Adoption and Corporate Pollution Emissions: Evidence from China" *Pacific-Basin Finance Journal* 90, 102647. doi:10.1016/j.pacfin.2024.102647, 2025 (with Rui Xu, Hao Zhang, and Minghui Han)
- "Do Winners Spread More Words? Factional Competition and Local Media Reports on Corruption Investigation in China" *Political Science Research and Methods* 12(2), 372-389. doi:10.1017/psrm.2022.35, 2024 (with Ji Yeon Hong)
- "性别认同，婚姻与女性劳动力供给: 教育与城乡差异的视角" 经济学（季刊）, 2021 (with 方颖, 蓝嘉俊)
- "排污费征收标准改革是否促进了中国工业二氧化硫减排" 世界经济, 2020 (with 方颖, 郭俊杰)

Other Publications

- "The Consumption of China's E-Commerce: Evidence from JD's Festival Sales", Chapter 9, *Handbook of U.S. Consumer Economics*, Academic Press, 2019 (with Wei Tian and Miaojie Yu)

Working Papers

- "Automated Verification of Reproducibility and Robustness at Scale in Social Science" (with Yiqing Xu) *Revise and Resubmit at Nature Human Behaviour*. Preprint: "Scaling Reproducibility: An AI-Assisted Workflow for Large-Scale Replication and Reanalysis", arXiv:2602.16733
- "Replication Certification at Publication: Checkable by Anyone, Anywhere, in Seconds, Forever" (with Gary King and Yiqing Xu)
- "Mandatory Identity Disclosure Reduces Cross-Group Participation: Evidence from a Natural Experiment" (with Yiqing Xu). Earlier version: "User Location Disclosure Fails to Deter Overseas Criticism but Amplifies Regional Divisions on Chinese Social Media", arXiv:2507.03238
- "Interpretable Discriminative Text Representations via Agreement and Label Disentanglement" (with Tong Wang and Yiqing Xu) arXiv:2605.20693. *Under Review at ICLR 2027*. Workshop version: "Agreement-Tested Coordinates: When Named Features Can Support Discovery, and When They Cannot". *Accepted, NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on Interpretability for Discovery (Interp4Discovery)*.
- "Discovering Interpretable Text Categories with Natural-Language Codebooks" (with Tianzhu Qin) *Under Review at ICLR 2027*
- "Separating Memory and Workflow Effects in Predicting Individual Answers" (with Tianzhu Qin, Lee Wei Jun, Kun Chen, Ramit Debnath, and Davin Youchao Dong) *Under Review at ICLR 2027*
- "The Pulse Beneath the Job Title: Monthly Readings of Requirements and Tasks from 750 Million Chinese Job Ads" (with Qin Chen, Ying Fang, and Xiangyu Wang) arXiv:2608.26924. *Under Review at Scientific Data*
- "Sanctioned but Shielded: Institutional Dependence and Selective Environmental Forbearance in China" (with Wenqian Tan, Rui Xu, and Hao Zhang) *Under Review at Journal of Management Studies*
- "Gaslighting: Comment Moderation on Chinese Social Media" (with Thomas Cao and Yiqing Xu)
- "Bias and Trust in LLM-Driven Screening Automation: Experimental Insights from FinTech Lending" (with Xiqian Cai, Yurou Wang, and Wenchao Xu) *Under Review at Journal of Corporate Finance*

Work in Progress

- "Don't Do Difference In Differences" (with Susan Athey, Guido Imbens, Yiqing Xu, and Xuelin Yang). Re-examines how difference-in-differences and two-way fixed effects designs are used in applied research. We assemble a corpus of more than 2,000 DID applications published in leading economics and political science journals since 2010, use an LLM-assisted pipeline to classify them and replicate a subset at scale, and develop new diagnostic tests for when the two-way fixed effects specification fails
- "Job Search and Career Choice in the Age of AI: Evidence from a University Job Platform" (with Xiqian Cai, Ying Fang, Yi Lu, and Basit Zafar). Uses a purpose-built job search platform for graduating students (`https://xmujob.com`) to study how students search for jobs and how AI shapes their career choices. The platform has been built and launched under a signed agreement with Xiamen University, with institutional support from the university's student affairs, career services, and

academic affairs offices; part of the NSFC Major Program project "Labor Market Theory and Micro-Structural Econometrics in the Age of Artificial Intelligence" (PI: Ying Fang, Xiamen University)

- "Uninsured Ground: Land Subsidence and House Prices in California" (with Ting Chen and Chang Liu). Studies how housing and mortgage markets price a natural hazard that formal institutions ignore: land subsidence from groundwater overdraft, which is excluded from homeowners insurance, hazard disclosure, and lending standards. We match parcel-level home sales in California's San Joaquin Valley to satellite-measured ground displacement. Preliminary draft completed

Research Grants

- Co-Principal Investigator (PI: Yiqing Xu), "AI Reproducibility", Stanford Impact Labs, Fast Grants for AI-Enabled Research ("Social Science, Supercharged"), Stanford University, US$50,000, 2026 - 2027
- Principal Investigator, Matching Scheme for Appointment of Research Assistant Professors (Faculty's Niche Research Areas), Research Committee, Hong Kong Baptist University, RAP/23-24/BUS/001, 2024 - 2026

Research Infrastructure and Knowledge Transfer

- ReproAI (`https://reproai.org`): an open infrastructure for certifying the computational reproducibility of published research, so that any reader can verify a replication package in seconds without rerunning it. Developed with Gary King (Harvard) and Yiqing Xu (Stanford), and now being integrated, in collaboration with the Dataverse team, into Dataverse, the open-source repository platform developed at Harvard's IQSS (about 150 installations worldwide). Its flagship installation, Harvard Dataverse, hosts the official replication archives of journals such as the *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, the *Journal of Political Economy*, the *Review of Economics and Statistics*, the *Review of Financial Studies*, the *American Political Science Review*, and the *American Journal of Political Science*. Supported by a Stanford Impact Labs Fast Grant for AI-Enabled Research
- China Modern Gazetteer Full-Text Database: full-text database of post-1949 Chinese county and city gazetteers, licensed to Stanford University, the University of Minnesota, the University of California, Berkeley, and the University of Michigan
- Chinese Job Market Tracker: a public dashboard monitoring labor market dynamics from online job postings

Honors and Fellowships

- IGCC Computational Social Science Fellowship, 2022
- Ichimore Student Research Award, 2020
- Sanford Lakoff Research Fellowship, 2020

Teaching Experience

Hong Kong Baptist University

Topics of ESG and Sustainability in Economics and Finance (ECON7095, MSc), Spring 2025, 2026 /Instructor

Applied Economics Research Paper (ECON7440, MSc), 2025-26 /Supervisor

Introduction to Web Scraping, Summer 2020 /Instructor

Other Teaching

Advanced Programming in Computational Social Science, UCSD, Fall 2021 /TA

Chinese Econ/Pol Capstone, UCSD, Winter 2020, 2021, 2022 /TA

Politics of People's Republic of China, UCSD, Fall 2017, Winter 2019 /TA

Making Policy with Data, UCSD, Winter 2018 /TA

Political Economy: Modern Capitalism, UCSD, Winter 2018 /TA

Advanced Econometrics, Xiamen University, Fall 2014 /TA

Service

Manuscript Referee

Information Systems Research, Journal of Comparative Economics, Political Behavior,
Journal of Chinese Political Science, Journal of Current Chinese Affairs,
Journal of Infrastructure, Policy and Development

Departmental and School Service

Admission interview panel, MSc in Business Management, School of Business, HKBU, 2026-27
Host of AEF research seminar speakers, HKBU, 2025-26
Academic advisor to undergraduate students, HKBU, 2025-26

Presentations

Seminars/Invited Talks

Invited Session, Data Mining Society, INFORMS Annual Meeting, San Francisco, Nov 2026 (scheduled)
Conference on AI, LLMs, and the Social Sciences (LLMSS), City University of Hong Kong, Oct 2026 (scheduled)
HKBU-SUSTech Joint Summer Workshop on Information Systems, Hong Kong Baptist University, Jul 2026
AI and Social Science Seminar, Guanghua School of Management, Peking University, Apr 2026
AI+ Social Sciences Workshop, Economics & Management School, Wuhan University, Nov 2025
Survey Data Center Seminar Series, IESR, Jinan University, Oct 2025
Zhongnan Accounting Seminar, Zhongnan University of Economics and Law, Apr 2025
Invited Talk Series, Southern University of Science and Technology, Feb 2025
Lecture Series on Innovation and Frontiers in Digital Economy, Fudan University, Dec 2024
SZ-HK Youth Scholars Exchange on Economics and Finance, Shenzhen University, Nov 2024
Chinese Historical Databases Meeting, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Jan 2024
Outstanding Young Scholars & Practitioners Support Program, Peking University, Aug 2023
Computational Social Science Workshop, Renmin University of China, Jul 2023
Forum for the Growth of Young Scholars in Internet Law, Wuhan University, May 2023